

SUPERVISED-ONLY PROJECT

One named, sober adult controls the launcher, fuel, ignition, commands, misfires, and cease-fire. Minors do not fuel, ignite, clear a misfire, or handle a loaded launcher. This set is educational guidance, not a certification of any component or assembly.

THE LEARNING SEQUENCE

Complete the paper models and cold measurements first. Live operation is optional, adult-controlled, outdoors only, and permitted only after every gate on the **Range Command Card** passes. Never change fuel, projectile fit, angle, or hardware merely to chase a larger result.

Model 1 · A bounded flame

Combustion is possible only inside a fuel's flammable range. Below its lower limit the mixture is too lean; above its upper limit it is too rich. That makes "more fuel" scientifically wrong as a general rule. Product formulation, sprayer, temperature, chamber history and mixing all vary, so this edition provides no universal dose.



Too lean · bounded region · too rich. The drawing is conceptual, not a dose scale.

Write before observing

Claim	A bounded mixture can ignite; mixtures outside the bounds may not.
Prediction	Adding fuel can move a mixture toward <i>or away from</i> the flammable region.
Safety consequence	Never top up a misfire; hold 60 seconds, vent fully, and return to the cold state. Never use liquid accelerants or oxygen enrichment.

Model 1 record

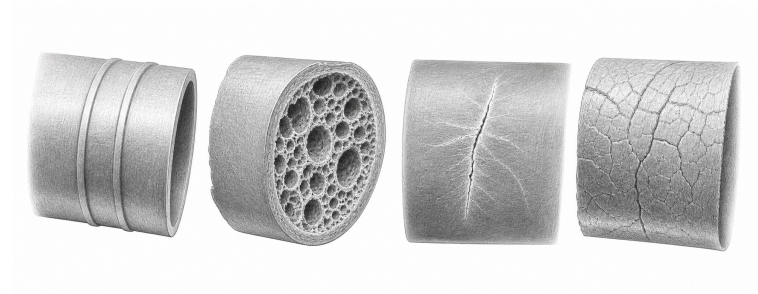
Draw a number line with an unnamed bounded region. Mark an initial mixture and two possible moves caused by "adding more." Why can the same action move toward safety in one sketch and away in the other?

What observation would *not* justify adding fuel? _____

Model 2 · Pressure is not approval

Heating gas in a constrained volume can raise pressure, but a plumbing pressure mark describes a listed plumbing product under specified conditions. It does not certify a homemade combustion assembly. Use only solid-wall, pressure-marked

pipe *and* pressure fittings; never DWV/cellular core and never compressed air or gas. Temperature, sunlight, impact, workmanship and chemical exposure can reduce margin.



Sound surface · cellular core · stress crack · crazing. A mark cannot cancel a defect.

Material audit		
Evidence read directly from every part	Pass/fail	Adult initials
Solid wall; pressure standard/rating; matching pressure fitting		
No DWV, cellular/foam core, cracks, whitening, crazing or deformation		
Cement/primer compatible; batch usable; label instructions retained		
Cure start recorded; 48 h minimum and manufacturer longer time satisfied		

Model 2 inspection questions		
Choose one real component and copy, do not paraphrase, its pressure marking: _____		
Under raking light, sketch any molding line and distinguish it from a crack. What changed when the part was rotated? _____		
Can a successful prior use prove the absence of accumulated damage? Explain: _____		

Model 3 · A useful trajectory, with a boundary

For launch speed v , angle θ , and gravity g , the no-drag model is

$$x(t) = v \cos(\theta)t, \qquad y(t) = v \sin(\theta)t - \frac{1}{2}gt^2.$$

It explains the parabolic ideal and separates horizontal from vertical motion. It does not include drag, potato shape, wind, launch-height difference, tumble, fragmentation, or shot-to-shot variation.



One ideal path versus a family of plausible outcomes under omitted effects.

Evidence table — observations, not performance tuning			
Trial	Cold/live	Predicted observation	Observed / uncertainty
1			
2			
3			

Model 3 uncertainty record		
Omitted variable	Direction predictable?	How the range gate handles it
Drag / irregular shape		
Wind / tumble		
Fragmentation / bounce		
Intermediate question: if three observations cluster, does that establish a safe boundary? Why not? _____		

Model 4 · Controls beat measurement

Impulse sound can injure immediately, and ordinary meters may clip the peak. Therefore a phone reading cannot clear the hazard. Distance, limited attendance, earplugs plus earmuffs, impact-rated eye protection, and a disciplined firing line remain required regardless of the displayed number.



Layered controls remain necessary when a phone waveform clips or misses the peak.

Model 4 measurement limits	
Displayed phone peak	_____
Sampling / clipping clue	_____
What remains unknown	_____
Controls retained regardless	distance; limited attendance; impact-rated eye protection; earplugs plus earmuffs; firing line

Claim · evidence · limitation synthesis			
Model	Claim supported	Evidence actually observed	Limitation retained
Bounded flame			
Material audit			
Trajectory			
Protective controls			

Diagnostic questions before the conclusion
1. Did the evidence contradict the prediction, or did the measurement fail to distinguish the alternatives? _____
2. Which result depends most on an assumption rather than a direct observation? _____
3. What additional <i>cold or paper</i> evidence could reduce uncertainty without changing a live-use variable? _____
4. Which unknown requires a stop decision rather than another trial? _____

A good conclusion
State what the model explained, what the evidence showed, and what remains unknown. The strongest result is often a justified stop decision. Do not report a PVC pressure rating as a combustion rating, a computed range as containment, or one successful firing as proof of safety.

Final evidence acceptance
For each model I recorded a prediction before observation, separated direct evidence from inference, named at least one uncertainty, and retained every safety control when the measurement could not resolve the hazard.
Most important stop decision: _____
Student / recorder _____ Adult review _____ Date _____

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